

Hospitable Go-Live Checklist

The Overhang | Altus Retreats | Direct Premium

HOW TO USE

Complete every Launch blocker before opening bookings. Recommended items reduce risk or improve the guest experience but can be finished in stages. Initial and date each section as you approve it.

Launch blockers at a glance

If these six gates pass, the remaining work is refinement rather than a reason to stay offline.

- ☐ Payout: Direct Premium is active and the correct bank account is verified and assigned.
- ☐ Inventory: Rates, fees, stay rules, advance notice, and availability are correct for bookable dates.
- ☐ Policy: A cancellation, payment, and service-fee policy is assigned to The Overhang.
- ☐ Tax: The exact property address is present and expected Kentucky/local taxes are understood.
- ☐ Guest journey: Confirmation, portal, agreement, access, and operational messages work.
- ☐ Test: One end-to-end booking has passed, including payment, channel blocking, and refund/cancellation.

1. Account, property, and payout

Owner: _____ Target date: _____

- ☐ Confirm Direct Premium is active under Settings > Plans & billing > Direct.
- ☐ Confirm The Overhang is enabled and eligible for Direct bookings.
- ☐ Verify the legal street address, time zone, USD currency, maximum occupancy, and check-in/check-out times.
- ☐ Confirm the connected Direct property is the correct Hospitable listing.
- ☐ Confirm the website widget uses the final property/site UUID.
- ☐ Add the Altus Retreats payout bank account and complete identity/business verification.
- ☐ Sign the required payment-services agreement and wait for a Verified status.
- ☐ Confirm that payout account is assigned to The Overhang; independently recheck routing and account numbers.

2. Calendar, rates, and stay rules

Review the guest-facing total, not only the base nightly rate.

- ☐ Verify nightly pricing for at least the next 12 months.
- ☐ Confirm weekday/weekend rates and holiday or event pricing.
- ☐ Confirm minimum-night rules and any maximum-stay limit.
- ☐ Set advance notice for last-minute reservations.
- ☐ Set the maximum booking window.
- ☐ Set preparation time between stays, if needed.
- ☐ Review check-in and checkout weekday restrictions.
- ☐ Review gap-night behavior and orphan-night rules.
- ☐ Confirm the cleaning fee.
- ☐ Confirm pet fees, extra-guest fees, and corresponding rules.
- ☐ Review weekly, monthly, early-bird, and last-minute discounts.
- ☐ Review the Direct channel markup separately from OTA markups.
- ☐ Confirm Airbnb, Vrbo, owner, maintenance, and personal-use blocks appear correctly in Hospitable.
- ☐ Test several available, unavailable, short-notice, and minimum-stay date combinations in the live widget.
- ☐ Manually calculate at least three quotes and reconcile nightly charges, cleaning, discounts, fees, and taxes.

APPROVAL

Pricing/calendar reviewed by: _____ Date: _____

3. Booking policy

Direct > Booking Policies. Existing reservations retain the policy applied when they were created.

- ☐ Create or select the cancellation policy for The Overhang.
- ☐ Confirm the free-cancellation window, partial-refund tiers, and non-refundable cutoff.
- ☐ Choose full payment or an installment schedule.
- ☐ Define when the remaining balance must be collected.
- ☐ Require full payment for reservations made close to arrival, if appropriate.
- ☐ Configure the grace period for failed scheduled payments.
- ☐ Choose the service-fee model: split fee or host-only fee.
- ☐ Explicitly assign the completed policy to The Overhang.
- ☐ Read every term from the guest's perspective and confirm checkout disclosure is clear.

4. Taxes and compliance

Direct Premium handles listed taxes based on the property address; unlisted local obligations remain the host's responsibility.

- ☐ Confirm the exact property address and jurisdiction in Hospitable.
- ☐ Review the taxes displayed under the property's Direct settings.
- ☐ Confirm Kentucky Sales Tax is calculated for qualifying stays.
- ☐ Confirm Kentucky Transient Room Tax is calculated for qualifying stays.
- ☐ Identify any county, city, tourism, or other local tax that may also apply.
- ☐ Document which party collects, files, and remits every applicable tax.
- ☐ Verify ordinary short-stay taxes using a test quote.
- ☐ Ask a tax professional about local or long-stay treatment if anything remains uncertain.
- ☐ Save screenshots or records of the final tax configuration.

IMPORTANT Hospitable states that Direct Premium remits Kentucky state sales and transient-room taxes for qualifying stays of 29 nights or less. Confirm any additional local obligation separately.

5. Verification, acceptance, and property protection

These settings determine who is accepted and what must be completed before arrival.

- ☐ Confirm Direct Premium guest verification is active.
- ☐ Choose request-to-book or Instant Book.
- ☐ If using Instant Book, confirm who monitors medium/high-risk requests requiring manual review.
- ☐ Create a rental agreement and scope it to future Direct reservations for The Overhang.
- ☐ Include occupancy, visitors, parties, smoking, pets, quiet hours, damage responsibility, checkout obligations, cancellation, and payment terms.
- ☐ Have qualified counsel review final legal language if relying on the agreement for enforcement.
- ☐ Decide whether signing is required before check-in messages are released.
- ☐ Decide whether to use a Hospitable-managed security deposit and set the amount.
- ☐ Disclose the deposit amount, authorization timing, release timing, and processor in guest-facing terms.
- ☐ Confirm damage-protection eligibility, exclusions, documentation needs, and claim deadlines.
- ☐ Create a pre-arrival condition-documentation routine and assign the post-checkout inspection.

6. Guest communications

Review every automation with the Direct channel selected. Messages should match the booking's actual status.

- ☐ Booking request received: explain that a request is not yet a confirmed stay.
- ☐ Booking confirmed: summarize dates, next steps, and support path.
- ☐ New reservation: include the %guest_portal% shortcode with explanatory text.
- ☐ Verification reminder: explain what is required and where to get help.
- ☐ Rental-agreement reminder: link to the Guest Portal and state the deadline.
- ☐ Failed-payment reminder: direct guests to update payment in the Guest Portal.
- ☐ Pre-arrival message: confirm arrival window, directions, parking, and what to expect.
- ☐ Check-in instructions: release only after required pre-stay tasks are complete.
- ☐ First-night follow-up: ask whether the guest arrived and whether anything needs attention.
- ☐ Checkout reminder: state checkout time and only essential departure steps.
- ☐ Post-stay message: thank the guest without conflicting with the guidebook's OTA-safe communication rules.
- ☐ Cancellation message: state the cancellation and refund outcome clearly.
- ☐ Remove any manual-payment language from Direct messages.
- ☐ Confirm door codes and sensitive access information are never sent too early.
- ☐ Confirm replies reach the correct Hospitable Inbox and that push/email notifications are enabled.
- ☐ Assign a backup responder for pending requests, payment issues, and urgent guest messages.

7. Operations and team readiness

A booking is only truly live when it reliably reaches the people and systems that operate the stay.

- ☐ Direct reservations create the correct cleaning task and turnover time.
- ☐ Cleaner and inspection notifications reach the correct people.
- ☐ Smart-lock codes generate correctly, if integrated.
- ☐ Maintenance and pre-arrival inspection tasks are created.
- ☐ Same-day booking procedures are documented.
- ☐ The team knows how to accept/decline, alter, cancel, refund, and request additional money.
- ☐ Someone is assigned to inspect promptly after checkout and preserve damage evidence.
- ☐ Emergency and after-hours responsibilities are assigned.

8. Required end-to-end launch test

Use an incognito browser, a separate guest email, and a real payment method. Record the test reservation number below.

- ☐ Open www.staytheoverhang.com in an incognito/private browser on desktop.
- ☐ Repeat the widget journey on a phone-sized screen.
- ☐ Confirm the widget shows The Overhang with the correct branding and property details.
- ☐ Search open dates and verify the expected availability.
- ☐ Search blocked dates and verify they cannot be reserved.
- ☐ Test minimum-stay, maximum-stay, and short-notice restrictions.
- ☐ Confirm the complete total matches the expected rate, discount, cleaning fee, service fee, and tax.
- ☐ Confirm cancellation and payment terms appear before submission.
- ☐ Confirm any security deposit is separately and clearly disclosed.
- ☐ Submit one genuine end-to-end test reservation.
- ☐ Confirm verification runs and the booking reaches the expected approval state.
- ☐ Confirm the payment or authorization behaves as configured.
- ☐ Confirm the reservation appears in the Hospitable Inbox and calendar.
- ☐ Confirm the dates block on every connected booking channel.
- ☐ Open the confirmation email and Guest Portal as the test guest.
- ☐ Complete the rental agreement and other required portal tasks.
- ☐ Confirm scheduled messages and operational tasks trigger correctly.
- ☐ Confirm access instructions remain withheld until the intended point.
- ☐ Cancel/refund the test using the real operating process.
- ☐ Confirm the refund status and verify the dates reopen across every channel.

Test reservation	
Dates tested	
Guest email	
Final guest total	
Expected payout	
Issues found / retest	

9. The Overhang website launch items

These are outside Hospitable but affect what guests and search engines see.

- ☐ Replace the live social-sharing title Altus Retreats - Direct Booking with property-specific Open Graph metadata.
- ☐ Add a property-specific social-sharing description and preview image.
- ☐ Confirm the final Hospitable widget/site UUID in the deployed website.
- ☐ Repoint bare staytheoverhang.com away from GoDaddy and to the CloudFront distribution.
- ☐ Verify both staytheoverhang.com and www.staytheoverhang.com use HTTPS and reach the same current site.
- ☐ Remove noindex,nofollow when public search indexing should begin.
- ☐ Increment static asset versions after CSS/JavaScript changes and invalidate CloudFront.
- ☐ Retest the live website after DNS and metadata caches have had time to update.

Helpful, but not required for day one

- ☐ Promo codes and repeat-guest offers.
- ☐ Guest upsells such as early check-in or add-ons.
- ☐ Google Vacation Rentals distribution.
- ☐ Hospitable-hosted website or custom Hospitable domain.
- ☐ Direct-booking review collection and display.
- ☐ Advanced payment schedules or multiple property-specific policies.
- ☐ Sophisticated dynamic pricing and automated marketing campaigns.

Final go-live sign-off

Do not sign until all launch blockers and the end-to-end test are complete.

Payout verified	Initials: _____	Date: _____
Pricing/calendar approved	Initials: _____	Date: _____
Policy/tax reviewed	Initials: _____	Date: _____
Guest journey tested	Initials: _____	Date: _____
Operations ready	Initials: _____	Date: _____
Approved to go live	Signature: _____	Date: _____

GO-LIVE RULE

If payout verification, tax responsibility, calendar accuracy, or the real booking test is unresolved, pause public bookings. Everything in the optional section can be completed after launch.